The Web Files

By Margie Palatini

INTRODUCTION

Vocalizes Opening Theme from Dragnet (1951-1959) *

Spoken as Ducktective Web: *Ladies and Gentlemen, the story you are about to see is true. The names have been changed to protect the innocent.*

This is the farm. Hundreds of animals. Most of them follow the course as planned. A few of them get lost along the way. When they do, it makes trouble for me. I'm a Ducktective. I carry a badge ***(flips open badge)***

In a normal voice: *The Web Files by Margie Palatini*

DUCKTECTIVE WEB: My partner, Bill, and I were working the barnyard shift. It was peaceful. Quiet. Then we got the call.

ROOSTER: Cock-a-doodle-doo!

BILL: A lot of squawking going on down in the coop area, Ducktective Web. Looks like fowl play. Report says feathers are flying. Chief says we should check out the chicks.

WEB: Chicks?

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BILL: Check.

WEB: Let's fly.

DUM DE DUM DUM

BILL: 6:35A.M. -- The hen's house.

WEB: We knocked on the door. She answered.

HEN: P'awk! P-p-p-awk! P'awk! P'awk! P'awk!

WEB: Just the facts, ma'am. Just the facts.

HEN: I've been robbed! *(unruffling her feathers)* Robbed, I tell you. Robbed! Robbed! Robbed!

DUCKTECTIVE WEB: So, you're saying that you were robbed, is that right, ma'am? What exactly is missing from the nest, ma'am? Eggs, ma'am? Chicks, ma'am?

HEN: *(flapping)* P-p-peppers.

WEB: Peppers?

HEN: My perfect purple peppers that were just about ready to be pickled.

WEB: About how many perfect purple almost-pickled peppers would you say were pilfered, pinched, and picked? A bushel?

HEN: *(Squawking)* P'awk! Pawk! No --- a peck! A peck, I tell you! A whole purple-pepper-pickin' peck!

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WEB: Have any idea who would pick a peck of your perfect purple almost-pickled peppers?

HEN: *(Clucking)* Not a clue.

DUCKTECTIVE WEB: *(Turning to Bill with a quack)* Round up the usual suspects.

DUM DE DUM DUM

BILL: 9:06 A.M. - Headquarters was hopping.

WEB: *(to audience)* A miss named Muffet had just been tossed off her tuffet and a gal named Peep was missing some sheep. I noticed that three little kittens had lost their mittens. They began to cry. I wanted to help. I couldn't. I had pickled peppers to worry about. We had Horner in the comer and were trying to make Little Boy Blue quack. *(To Little Boy Blue)* Okay, Blue Boy. Quit blowing your horn. Time to make hay. Suppose you just tell me where you were this morning.

LITTLE BOY BLUE: *(Quivering)* I'm innocent, I tell you! Innocent! I was under the haystack. Fast asleep! Honest. Ask anybody.

WEB: Sure. Sure. I've heard that bedtime story before. *(To Bill)* Got any witnesses?

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BILL: *(Shaking his head)* No. The sheep were in the meadow. Cows were in the com.

WEB: Things looked black for the boy in blue. And then. . . we got another call. **Ring Ring**

BILL: *(Answering, he listens with some Uh-huhs, then to Web)* There's been some horsin' around reported down near Barn and Pen, Looks like another robbery.

WEB: We put the kid out to pasture.

DUM DE DUM DUM

BILL: 10:43 A.M. - Comer of Barn and Pen

WEB: *(to audience)* Bill and I talked to the horses. *(calling out to the horses)* Whoa! Whoa! You there. Like to ask you a few questions if you don't mind, sir.

HORSE: Na-a-a-ay. Not at all.

WEB: What do you know about a peck of unlawfully picked perfect purple almost-pickled peppers?

HORSE: Peppers? Peppers? A peck of purple peppers? Not a thing. But somebody just hightailed it out of here with a tub of my tartest, tasty to**MAH**toes!"

WEB: Tomatoes?

HORSE: You say to-**MAY**-toes . . . I say to-**MAH**-toes . . .

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Somebody just hauled the whole thing off!

SHEEP: *(Sighing)* And find my lettuce while you're at it, too! Somebody just lifted a load of my luscious leafy lettuce not ten minutes ago! This is ba-a-a-d! Really ba-a-a-d!

BILL: (Scratching his head) Peppers? Tomatoes? Lettuce? What do you make out of all of this, Web?

WEB: There was only one thing to make out of all of this. Salad.

DUM DE DUM DUM

BILL: 11:47 A.M. -- The squad room

WEB: My partner and I were still trying to quack the case, but we didn't have any idea whom to I.D.

BILL: Rats!

WEB: That's it! There was only one suspect who was sneaky enough, wily enough, and tricky enough to pick a peck of perfect purple almost-pickled peppers, take a tub of tasty tart tomatoes, and lift a load of luscious leafy lettuce. My partner and I were hot on the tail of . . . That Dirty Rat.

DUM DE DUM DUM

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BILL: 12:46 P.M. - A real hole -in-the-wall.

WEB: *(Pounding on the door)* We know you're holed up in there, you Dirty Rat. Let us in.

RAT: *(Opening the door)* Eh, what's up, Duck?

WEB: There's been some trouble down on the farm. What do you know about a rash of recent robberies?

RAT: *(Innocently)* Robberies? Robberies? What makes you think I know anything about a robbery? I'm no cheesy snitch.

WEB: Can it, Ratzo. You've been in nothing but garbage for years.

RAT: *(Smirking)* Okay. Sure. Sure. Go ahead, flatfoot. Look anywhere you want. But make it quick, Quacker. . . you're interrupting my lunch.

WEB: *(looking past him at the Rat's table)* Lunch, eh, Rodent?

RAT: *(hissing)* Hey, what's going on here? You're not going to pin this rap on me. Where's your evidence, you waddling webfoot? You got nothing on me. Nothing, see? I'm clean! Clean, I tell you. Clean!

WEB: *(picking a piece of lettuce from under his chin)* Not clean enough, you Dirty Rat. *(he smells Rat's breath)*

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Just as I suspected. Garlic mayo. Book him, Ducko. His salad days are over.

RAT: *(Crying, as his hands are cuffed and he is led away)* Over? Over? But they can't be over! I haven't even had my dessert!

BILL: *(Patting Web on the back)* Looks like you quacked another one, Web. But how did you ever figure it was him?

WEB: Just played a hunch. He ate the evidence for lunch . . . and forgot to use his napkin and brush his teeth. He's a dirty rat. He never did have good hygiene.

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WEB: The Dirty Rat was tried and convicted on three counts of vegetable vagrancy, offensive bad breath, and not using a napkin to wipe under his chin. He was sent up the river and was sentenced to six months of farm labor with time off for good behavior, better table manners, and clean teeth. CASE CLOSED.

DUM DE DUMDUM DUM DE DUMDUM DUM DUM!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Margie Palatini
ISBN: 978-0786804191
Publisher: Hyperion
Date (Month/Year): May 2001

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2009 National Qualifier
IA State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

****Thematic Opening for Dragnet 1951-1959***
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o1hgGchn8p8

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